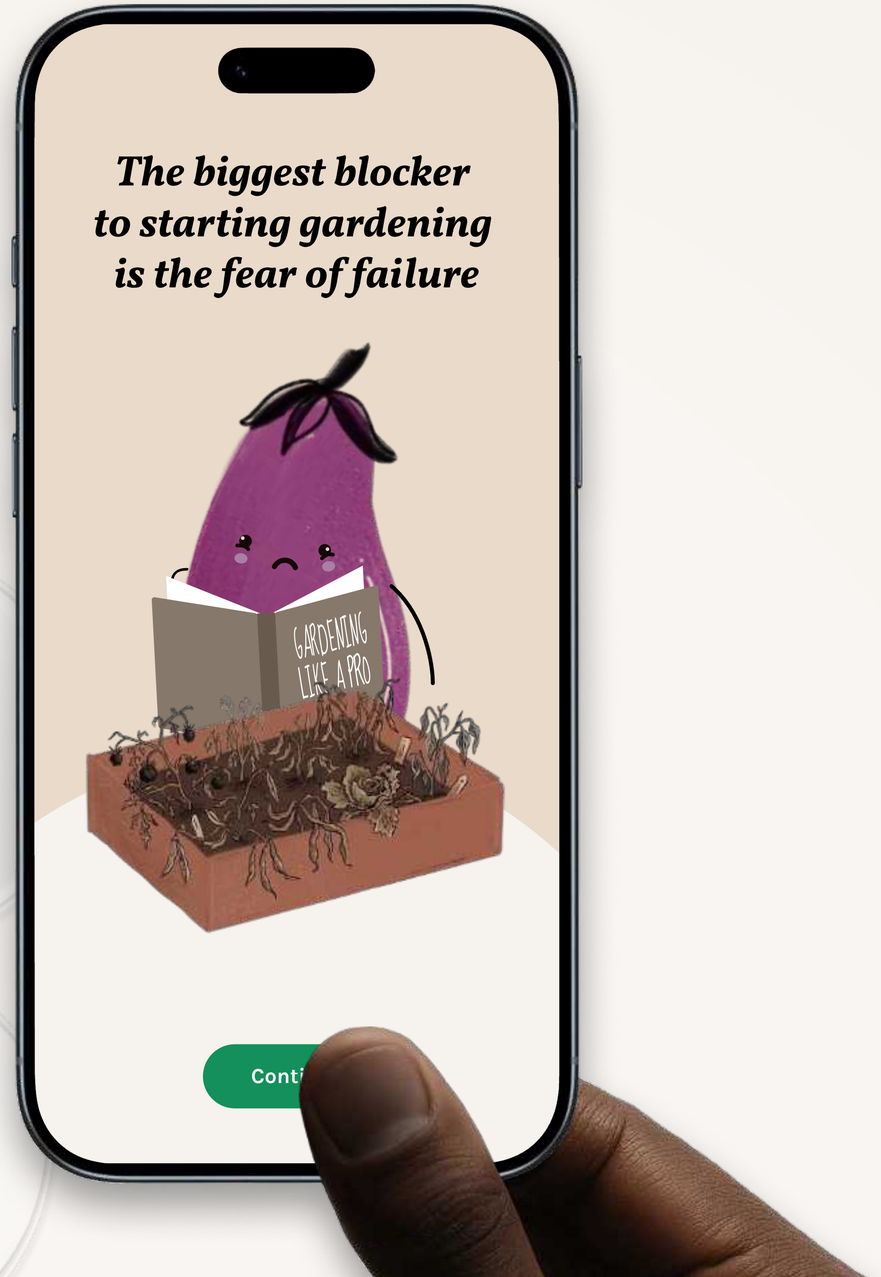
From Intuition to Evidence: Onboarding Experience at Fryd



Year

2024-2026

Role

End-to-end

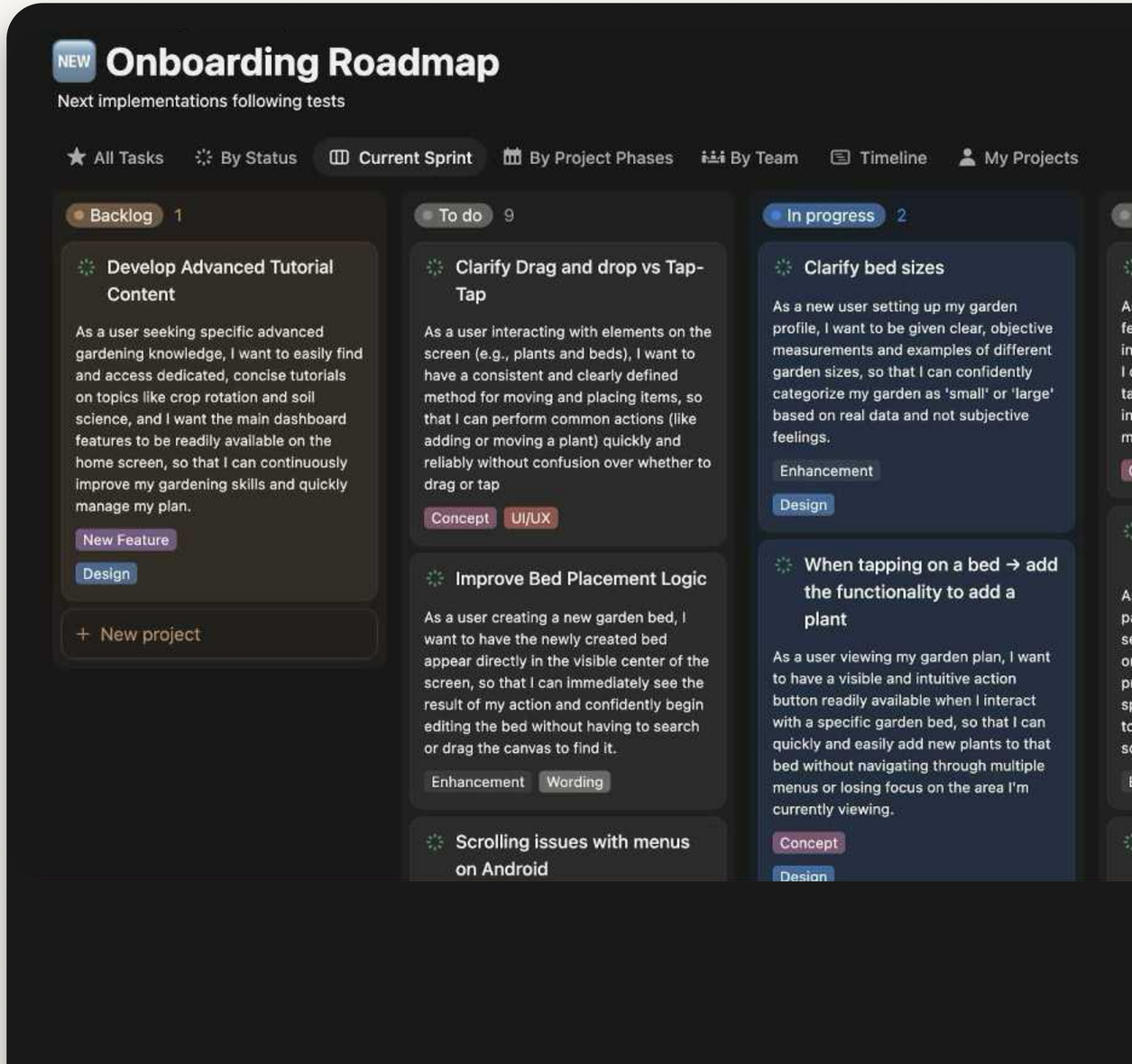
Onboarding Roadmap

Experimentation Strategy

“Honestly, few people have had a bigger impact on how we work than Alice. She pushed us to A/B test new features properly instead of going with our gut. She ran user research on her own initiative, before anyone asked, and she kept turning up with ideas for things we hadn't thought of yet.”

Florian Haßler

CEO and Head of Product



Context

When I joined Fryd, onboarding was a yearly big redesign. Conversion performance was poorly understood, and product decisions relied largely on gut feeling.

I owned the onboarding experience end-to-end, from identifying opportunities and prioritizing the roadmap to designing solutions, running experiments, and evaluating results.

Over two years, I led a continuous optimization process involving 30+ experiments and user tests. I established the analytics foundations needed to measure user behavior, introduced GrowthBook for A/B testing, and iteratively tested different approaches to onboarding.

Beyond redesigning the experience, I helped establish a more systematic, evidence-based approach to product design, turning onboarding into a journey the team could measure, test, and continuously improve.

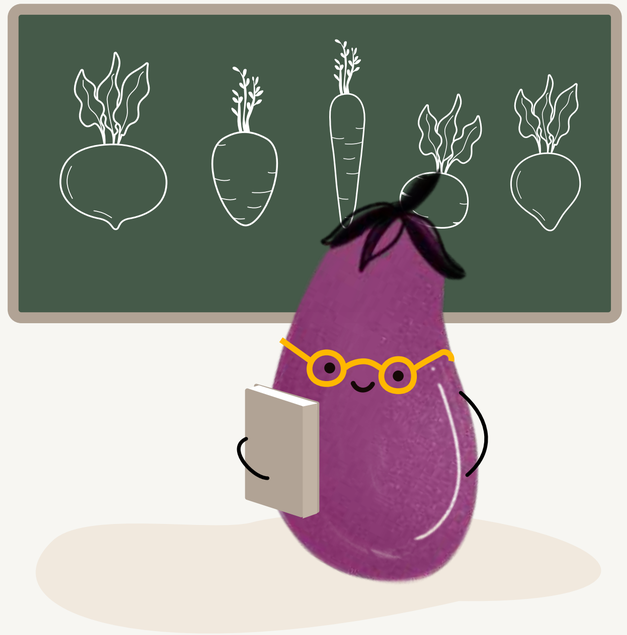
Goal

Increase sign up to trial conversion rate

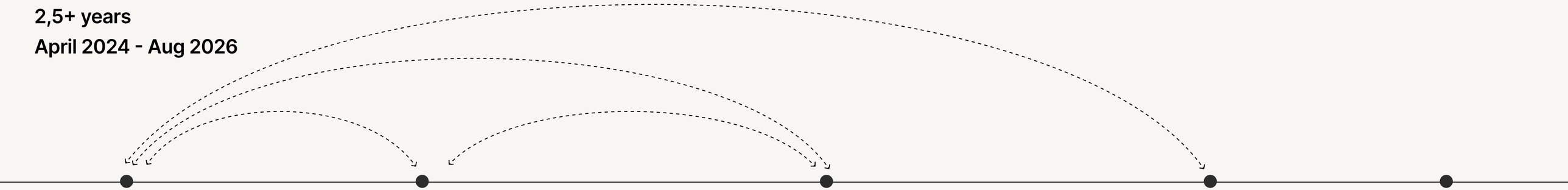
Bring more users to the realization moment

Challenge

Onboarding redesigns were occasional and driven by intuition, with no standardized analytics or reliable conversion measurements to evaluate their effectiveness.



2,5+ years
April 2024 - Aug 2026



PRIORITISATION

Figjam

Notion + AI

MONITORING
ANALYSING

Clarity

Mixpanel

LookerStudio

RESEARCH / EXPLORATION

Google Meet

External
UX Agency

Electric Twin AI

NotebookLM AI

Claude AI

User interviews +
Usability Tests

A/B TESTING

Growthbook

External
UX Agency

HANDOFF

Figma + AI

Claude AI

Growthbook





Experiment	Tags	Date	Status	Result
Onboarding App Area Selection (2nd Try)		started Aug 26, 2026	Running	
Onboarding App Area Selection		ended Aug 26, 2026	Stopped	Didn't fir
Onboarding Surface the Pain		ended May 19, 2026	Stopped	Won
No-Freemium-Plan		ended May 6, 2026	Stopped	Won
Paywall Position in Tutorial		ended Mar 3, 2026	Stopped	Lost
Emotional Onboarding		ended Feb 10, 2026	Stopped	Won
Onboarding Time Commitment		ended Feb 10, 2026	Stopped	Won
Web Library CTA Modal Variants	web	ended Jan 19, 2026	Stopped	Won
New Onboarding Tutorial		ended Jan 19, 2026	Stopped	Won
Benefits on First Screen		ended Dec 23, 2025	Stopped	Won
Simple Paywall		ended Oct 7, 2025	Stopped	Lost
Onboarding Webflow Paywall	web	ended Sep 3, 2025	Stopped	Lost
Paywall Outcomes		ended Jul 29, 2025	Stopped	Won
Onboarding Paywall		ended Apr 7, 2025	Stopped	Won
Onboarding Outcomes		ended Mar 25, 2025	Stopped	Won
Paywall Messaging		ended Feb 7, 2025	Stopped	Lost

Experiment 1 - Surfacing the Pain

Type

A/B/C

Duration

1 month

Users

7,600

- **Low effort**
- **High impact**

Hypothesis

WE OBSERVED

The current onboarding asks users about their gardening experience and setup, but doesn't explicitly address the frustrations that make gardening difficult. Users struggle with plant failures, complexity, and the feeling of not knowing what to do.

WE BELIEVE THAT...

Explicitly acknowledging users' gardening frustrations and emotional pain points will make the onboarding feel more personally relevant, helping users feel understood and increasing their motivation to continue.

AND TO VERIFY THIS, WE WILL...

A/B/C test the existing onboarding against a new flow that introduces pain-point selection, emotional triggers, validation, and desired outcomes before presenting social proof and continuing with setup.

AND MEASURE...

- Onboarding completion rate
- Trial-to-paid conversion rate
- Time to first plan
- DAU/WAU (7-day)

WE PREDICT THAT...

Users exposed to the pain-focused onboarding will show higher onboarding completion and trial-to-paid conversion rates than users in the control group.

AND IF WE'RE RIGHT, WE WILL...

Integrate the pain-focused sequence into the core onboarding experience, using customer language and emotional relevance to strengthen the value proposition and improve conversion.

A

Control

Intent

Pain

Surface the pain

Emotional trigger

Trust

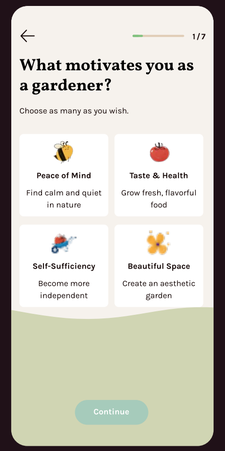
Desired outcome

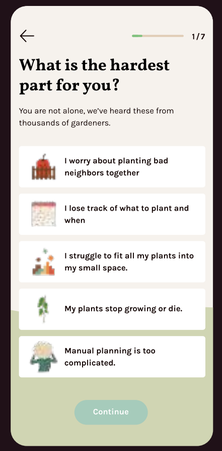
Pain validation

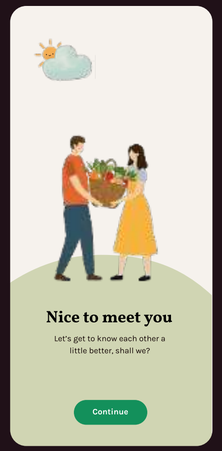
Emotional validation

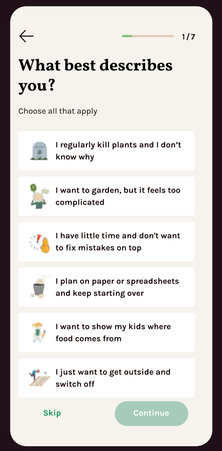
Outcome Validation









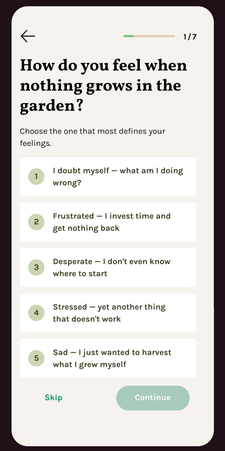




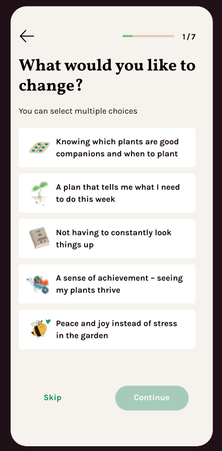
B

Surfacing the pain







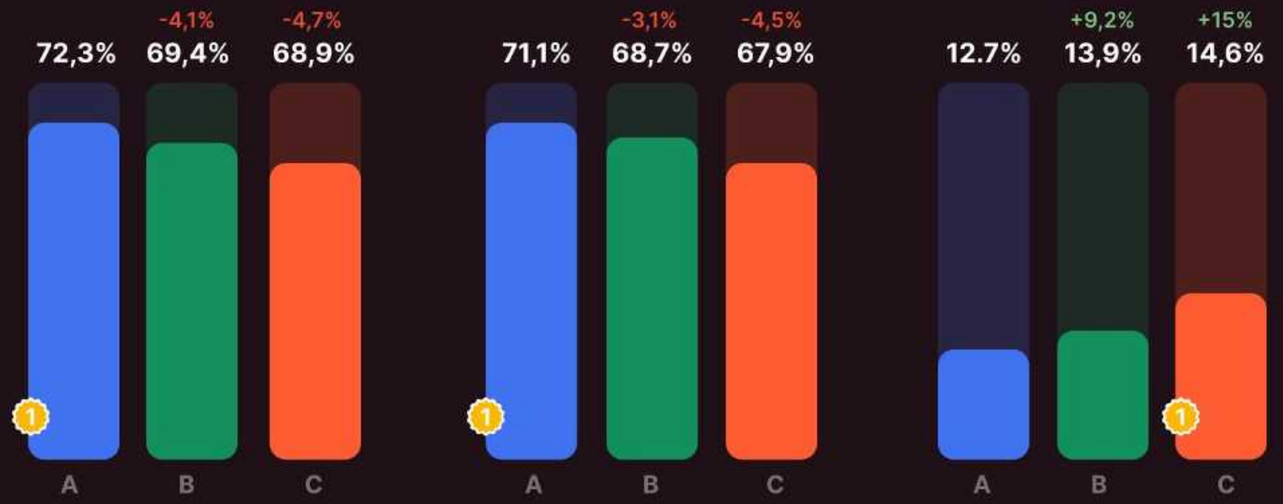






C

Adding validation





Results

Both variations slightly reduced onboarding and first plan completion compared to the control, but improved payment-start conversion.

With a business goal towards revenue, variant C is the strongest choice, because it delivers a significant lift in the primary conversion metric (paywall = trial started).

As payment intent doesn't guarantee a completed purchase. We built a cohort to track the participants and how they converted post-onboarding.

Among users who saw the paywall, 10,1% of those assigned variant C completed a purchase within 1 week which represents a 19% relative lift in purchase conversion.

Experiment 2 - Gamified Tutorial

Type

A/B

Usability Tests

Duration

2 month

Users

21,000

- **High effort**
- **High impact**

Hypothesis

EXPERIMENT GOAL

Increase new-user activation by helping users understand Fryd's core features and experience the product's value during onboarding.

WE OBSERVED

Users need to perform several core actions to experience Fryd's value. Users who add more than two plants to their plan tend to stick around, but not enough users reach this level of engagement.

WE BELIEVE THAT...

A guided, task-based tutorial that teaches users basic functionalities and advanced gardening topics will help them understand the product's core functionality and reach activation.

AND TO VERIFY THIS, WE WILL...

Redesign the tutorial around three basic chapters, using a guided character, contextual instructions, and hands-on interactions. We will compare the new experience against the existing tutorial through a 50/50 A/B test and conduct usability interviews with prospective users.

AND MEASURE...

Primary: Activation rate after the tutorial, based on reaching the defined activation threshold.

Secondary: Tutorial completion rate, tutorial exits and skips, and time to first plant after the tutorial.

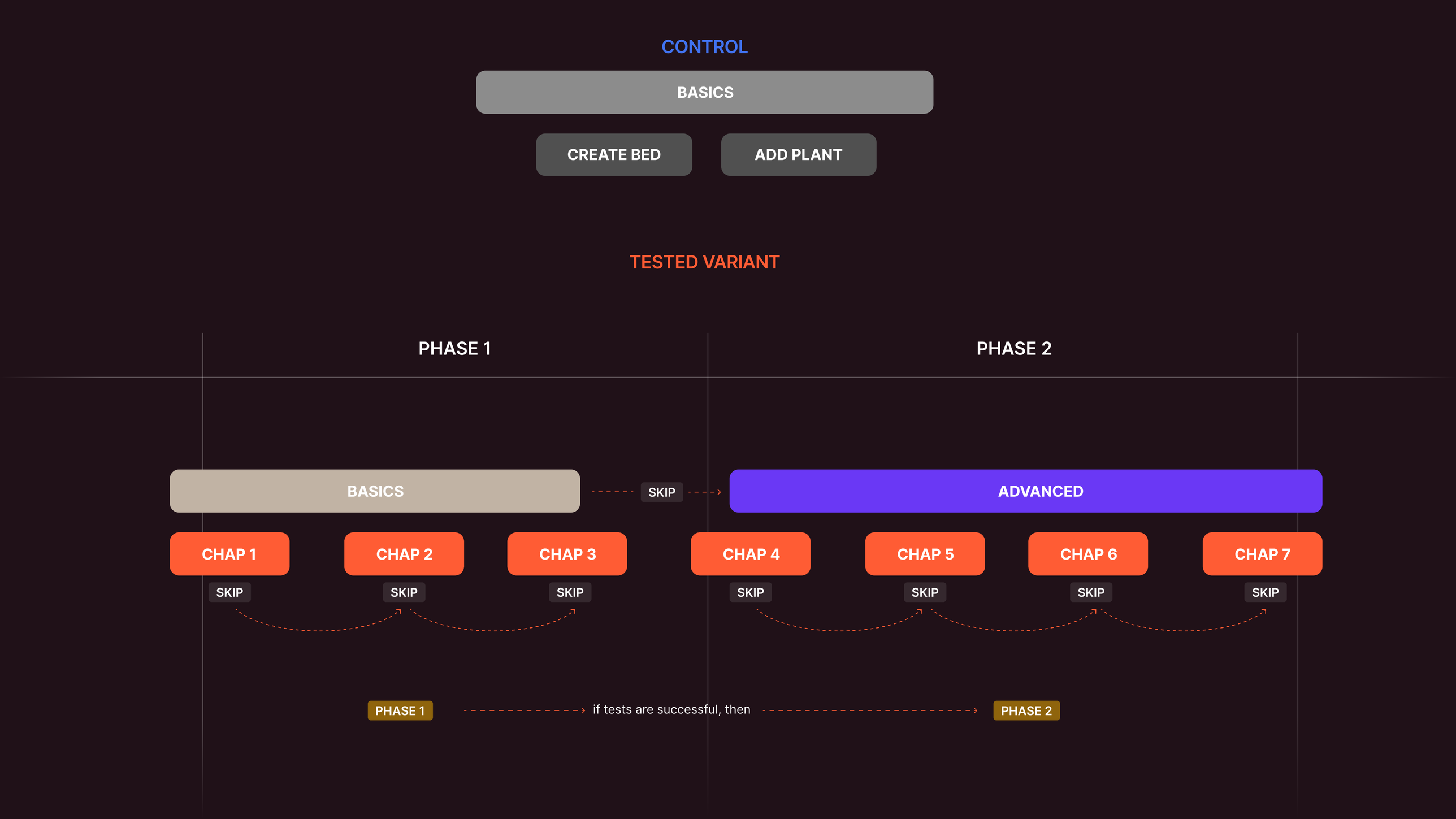
Longer-term: Day 7 and Day 30 retention to assess whether the experience contributes to sustained engagement.

WE PREDICT THAT...

Users who complete the redesigned tutorial will be more likely to reach activation than users who experience the existing tutorial.

AND IF WE'RE RIGHT, WE WILL...

Roll out the redesigned tutorial and use the findings to prioritize further improvements, including an advanced tutorial tailored to more experienced gardeners.


CONTROL
BASICS
CREATE BED
ADD PLANT
TESTED VARIANT
PHASE 1
PHASE 2
BASICS
SKIP
ADVANCED
CHAP 1
CHAP 2
CHAP 3
CHAP 4
CHAP 5
CHAP 6
CHAP 7
SKIP
SKIP
SKIP
SKIP
SKIP
SKIP
SKIP
PHASE 1
if tests are successful, then
PHASE 2

Independent Use

10/10

Progressive disclosure led to users feeling less overwhelmed and discovering new features on the second use, rather than discovering everything at once.

Perceived Added Value

9/10

Users recognized the value in planning, simplifying complexity, consolidating gardening knowledge, and supporting decisions.

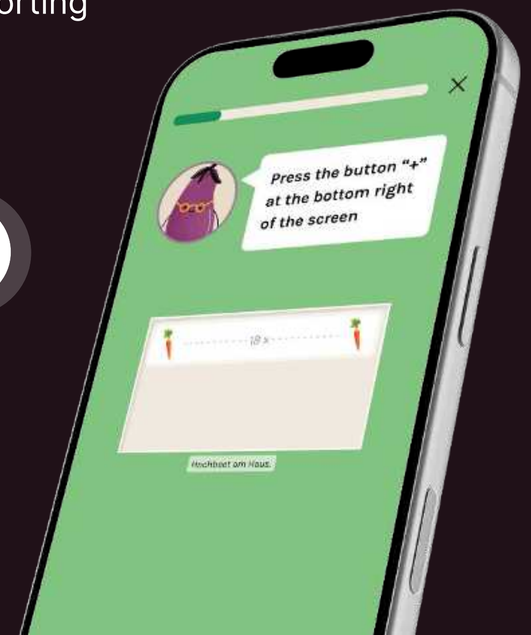
Usability Ratings

6-8/10

Fixing UX issues: e.g. text timings, confusing save button

Several prototypes limitations biased the results, e.g. forcing selection of a certain plant

PROTOTYPE



Next

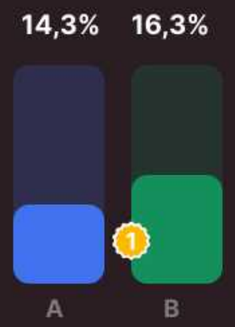
- [x] Validation of concept
- [ ] New round of usability testing on live build
- [ ] A/B test
  Compare the existing tutorial to the new one

Results

Not only more users reached the realization moment and added plants to their plan, but more users started a trial.

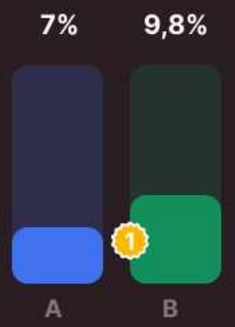
realization moment
(5+ core action)

RELATIVE LIFT
+9,7%



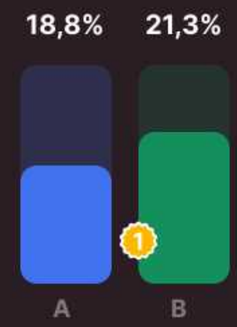
hard activation
(20+ core action)

RELATIVE LIFT
+40%



GUARDRAIL
trial started

RELATIVE LIFT
+13,4%



Users who completed the new tutorial were more likely to return to the app both at D7 and D30.

An increase in hard activated users is encouraging but could be biased, as motivation in users within a group can vary significantly.

D7

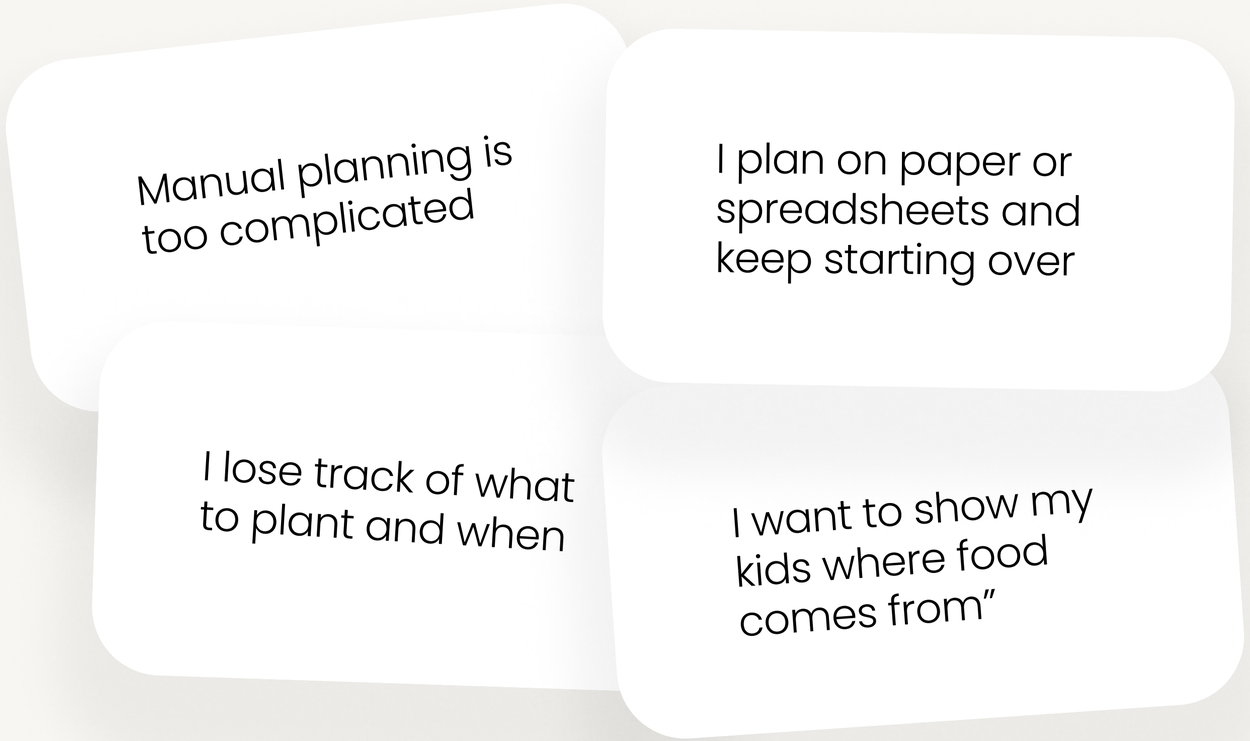
RELATIVE LIFT
+25%

D30

RELATIVE LIFT
+27,8%

Overall, the new tutorial helped more users reach value, start a trial and stay engaged.

Learnings



SHORT ONBOARDING YES BUT...

A shorter onboarding may increase completion when the product is straightforward and easy to understand.

We have throughout the years, doubled the screens at onboarding to only convert users who understood what the Fryd stood for, and filter users for whom the product isn’t for, drop during onboarding. Users who stay through a longer onboarding are the ones most likely to pay

WE ARE NOT SELLING GARDENING

We are selling a companion and a community to reduce stress and bring our users to do what is therapeutical for them: gardening. Users convert for organisation and meaning (family, food, a plan that sticks), not for plant rescue.

IT’S OKAY TO BE SELECTIVE

For years we designed for gardening experts. But we know now, newcomers convert best, this is our audience.